

Personal Statement Guide

Show your story • Highlight your impact • Build your future

A strong personal statement isn't just about what you've done — it's about who you are, what you've learned, and where you're going.

Your story matters



1

The Hook & Core Purpose

(Paragraph 1)

- **Opening Hook:** Start with a compelling narrative, pivotal moment, or central passion driving your goals. (Avoid cliché quotes or opening with "My name is...").
- **Thesis Statement:** Explicitly state what field you want to study and your long-term objective.
- **Key Prompt to Answer:** What specific vision or problem drives your academic pursuit?



Ask yourself: What made you choose this path? What do you hope to achieve?

2

Academic Background & Skills

(Paragraphs 2–3)

- **Academic Milestones:** Detail relevant coursework, research projects, or self-directed learning relevant to your chosen field.
- **Overcoming Challenges:** Briefly explain how you navigated academic or financial constraints, highlighting resilience and resourcefulness.
- **Key Prompt to Answer:** What concrete evidence proves you have the intellectual capacity to succeed in this program?



Ask yourself: What have you learned? What challenges have you overcome? What makes you ready?

3

Leadership & Community Impact

(Paragraph 4)

- **Real-World Initiative:** Describe a leadership experience, volunteer effort, or community initiative you spearheaded or significantly contributed to.
- **Measurable Results:** Quantify your impact (e.g., "Trained 15 students," "Organized workshops for over 50 community members").
- **Key Prompt to Answer:** How do you use your skills to serve others and create tangible change?



Ask yourself: How have you made a difference? Who have you helped? What was the result?

4

Future Vision & Program Fit

(Paragraph 5)

- **Short- & Long-Term Goals:** Explain what you plan to do immediately after completing your studies, and where you see yourself in 5–10 years.
- **Why This Specific Opportunity:** Name specific professors, courses, or values of the scholarship provider that align with your mission.
- **Key Prompt to Answer:** Why is this scholarship the exact bridge you need to reach your goals, and how will society benefit from investing in you?



Ask yourself: How does this program fit your journey? What will you contribute to the world?

Your goals. Your story. Your future.

